

8. Most rich state in minerals in India is –

- (a) Rajasthan
- (b) Madhya Pradesh
- (c) Bihar
- (d) Orissa

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (c)

During the time, when this question was asked, the state of Bihar was rich in mineral production. According to Indian Bureau of Mines annual report 2023-24. Present situation in terms of mineral production on value Odisha > Chhattisgarh > Rajasthan > Karnataka > Maharashtra > Jharkhand.

9. Which State of India is called as the State of Minerals ?

- (a) Odisha
- (b) West Bengal
- (c) Bihar
- (d) Jharkhand

70th B.P.S.C Re-Exam 2024

Ans. (a)

Odisha is often referred to as the "State of Minerals" because it is rich in a variety of mineral resources, including coal, iron ore, bauxite, and chromite. The state accounts for a significant share of India's total mineral production. It has some of the largest deposits of bauxite and chromite in the country, as well as a substantial share of manganese and iron ore.

10. Given below are two statements. One labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R) :

Assertion (A) : Gondwana System of Rocks provides about 95% of the coal of India.

Reason (R) : Most of the ferrous and non-ferrous minerals are associated with the Dharwar system of rocks.

Select the correct answer from the codes given below:

Codes :

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are correct, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
- (b) Both (A) and (R) are correct, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
- (c) (A) is true, but (R) is false.
- (d) (A) is false, but (R) is true.

U.P. P.C.S. (Mains) 2017

Ans. (b)

According to Indian Minerals Yearbook, 2022 Gondwana system of Rocks provides 99.54% (until April 1, 2022) of the coal in India. The important coal-bearing areas of this series are Raniganj, Jharia, Karanpur and Bokaro of the Damodar Basin in Odisha, and the Pench Valley in Chhattisgarh and Madhya Pradesh. **Dharwar system of Rocks** : They are named Dharwar system because they were first studied in the Dharwar region of Karnataka. The Dharwar system is rich in ferrous and non-ferrous minerals.

11. Non-metallic mineral is :

- (a) Marble
- (b) Manganese
- (c) Silver
- (d) Lead

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (a)

Marble is a non-metallic mineral among the given options. According to Minerals of Mine annual report 2023-24, India produces as many as 95 minerals, which include 4 fuel, 10 metallic, 23 non-metallic, 3 atomic and 55 minor minerals (including building and other materials). Manganese, Silver and Lead are metallic minerals. Silver is commonly found in acidic igneous rock mixed with lead zinc, copper etc.

B. Metallic Minerals

i. Iron-Ore

*Iron Ores in India are majorly found in Dharwar rock system.

Dharwar Rock System is economically most important rock system found in India.

Haematite and magnetite are the most important Iron Ores in India. About 79% haematite ore deposit are found in the Eastern Sector (Assam, Bihar, Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand, Odisha and Uttar Pradesh) while about 93% magnetic ore deposit occur in Southern Sector (Andhra Pradesh, Goa, Karnataka, Kerala and Tamil Nadu). Karnataka alone contributes 72% of magnetite deposit in India. Of these, haematite is considered to be superior because of its higher grade. Indian deposits of haematite belong to the Precambrian Iron Ore Series and the Ore is within banded iron ore formations occurring as massive, laminated, friable and also in powdery form.

*The high-quality iron ore (Haematite and Magnetite) is explored from **Bailadila Mine** of Chhattisgarh. Bailadila Mine is the **largest mechanized mine** of India. Iron ore explored from this mine is exported to **Japan** from **Vishakhapatnam Port**.